

IDS11072
Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia

Issued at 3:40 am CST on Thursday 21 May 2026
for the period until midnight CST Saturday 23 May 2026.

Please be aware

Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A high pressure system over SA will remain dominant as it slowly moves east and into the Tasman Sea on Friday. A cold front move across across South Australia over the weekend, followed by another high pressure system.

Far West Coast: WA-SA Border to Fowlers Bay

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots tending east to northeasterly in the early afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the afternoon. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1.5 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots tending northerly in the early morning. Winds reaching up to 25 knots offshore during the morning. Seas: 1 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1 metre by early evening. Swell: Southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres inshore, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres offshore during the afternoon. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northwest to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots tending northwest to southwesterly during the morning then tending south to southwesterly during the day. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm.

Upper West Coast: Fowlers Bay to Elliston

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots becoming variable about 10 knots in the early afternoon then becoming east to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots turning northerly before dawn. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots shifting south to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots during the afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the afternoon or evening. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5

metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the afternoon and evening.

Lower West Coast: Elliston to Cape Carnot

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots becoming variable below 10 knots in the late afternoon then becoming northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the late evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning northerly 15 to 20 knots before dawn. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: North to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning west to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots during the evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the evening. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm.

Central Coast

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: Northerly 10 to 15 knots turning northeasterly in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots in the west during the day. Winds turning northerly in the early morning. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres in the west during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots tending northwest to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots during the evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the evening. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the afternoon.

South Central Coast

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: North to northwesterly 10 to 15 knots decreasing to about 10 knots in the early afternoon then tending north to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning northerly 15 to 20 knots early in the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres west of Kangaroo Island. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots turning west to northwesterly 10 to 15 knots during the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres west of Kangaroo Island. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers.

Upper South East Coast: Murray Mouth to Cape Jaffa

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the late evening. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Becoming cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Lower South East Coast: Cape Jaffa to SA-VIC Border

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: West to northwesterly below 10 knots tending northerly 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: Northerly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres offshore during the afternoon. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres, decreasing to 2 metres during the afternoon or evening. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: North to northeasterly about 10 knots tending east to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Port Neill to Port Victoria. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming easterly 10 to 15 knots in the evening then tending northeasterly in the late evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots becoming north to northwesterly below 10 knots in the early afternoon then tending north to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the late afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Becoming cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning northerly during the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: North to northeasterly about 10 knots tending east to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Becoming cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre.
Weather: Partly cloudy.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 9:30 am CST Thursday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.